Institutional Capacity Workshop

Facilitator Outline — Enabling Tourism Marketing & SME Competitiveness in The Gambia

ITC EU Youth Empowerment Project (YEP) — Tourism and Creative Industries

Banjul, The Gambia | May 2026

How to use this document: This outline provides session-by-session content guidance for facilitating the two-day institutional workshop. Each session includes talking points, references to specific findings from the digital assessment deliverables, and suggested activities with alternates. It is intended as the basis for PowerPoint slide development and facilitator preparation.

Data references: References marked in blue italic text point to specific findings from Deliverable 1 (Creative Industries Digital Baseline Assessment) and Deliverable 2 (Regional Benchmarking & Market Positioning Analysis). These can be used directly as slide content or discussion anchors.

THURSDAY MORNING — Setting the Scene (~3 hours)

Session 1 — Destination Positioning: Where Does The Gambia Stand Today? (75 min)

Opening Frame

- The purpose of this session is not to evaluate what the GT Board or other institutions have done, but to look together at what the data shows about how The Gambia is seen from the outside — and what that means for the work institutions do.
- Frame the session as a shared reading of evidence, not a critique. The findings are a starting point for conversation, not conclusions.

The Gambia's Current Positioning — What the Data Shows

- Tourism to The Gambia is currently dominated by two narratives in international markets: beach/resort and wildlife/birdwatching.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 3.2: 95% of international tour operator pages include beach/resort framing; 91% include wildlife/nature. Cultural heritage appears in 74% but rarely as a primary selling point.*
- Creative industries — festivals, crafts, music, performing arts — remain largely absent from how The Gambia is sold internationally.
- *Deliverable 2, Table 10: The Gambia's Creative Tourism Score averages 16.9/100, compared to a regional mean of 30.9. Only 9% of operator pages highlight Gambian creative content, vs 26% for Senegal and 21% for Ghana.*
- This is not a reflection of what The Gambia has to offer — it reflects what is currently being communicated through international channels.

Who Is Coming and Why

- The UK and Netherlands together account for nearly 80% of identifiable TripAdvisor reviews — these are The Gambia's dominant source markets for cultural tourism.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 4.4: UK/Anglophone visitors represent 45% of reviews (avg rating 4.32/5); Dutch/Belgian visitors represent 34% (avg rating 4.56/5 — the highest of any group).*
- Francophone visitors (France, Francophone Africa) represent only 15% of current reviews — significantly below what geography and proximity would suggest.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 4.4: Francophone segment avg rating 4.06/5; main barrier identified is near-total absence of French-language content.*
- German, Austrian, and Swiss visitors (3%) are primarily wildlife-focused; Spanish and Italian visitors (3%) are drawn by artistic quality.

The Gap Between Intention and Perception

- Visitor sentiment is generally positive — The Gambia scores above regional average across most themes — but the country is described as 'liked but not looked for.'
- *Deliverable 2, Executive Summary: 'The Gambia possesses authentic creative assets and generates positive visitor sentiment relative to the region, yet remains digitally invisible in the global cultural-tourism marketplace.'*
- The Gambia ranks first regionally in safety perception — a significant competitive advantage that is rarely foregrounded in marketing.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 4.2: Safety & Security is The Gambia's strongest sentiment theme relative to regional peers.*
- The core challenge is communicative, not structural. The country has stories to tell but lacks the platforms, language accessibility, and operator partnerships to tell them effectively.

Regional Positioning Context

- Compared to regional peers, The Gambia ranks 4th of 6 destinations in creative industries digital maturity — ahead of Benin but behind Senegal, Cape Verde, Ghana, and Nigeria.
- *Deliverable 2, Table 1: Regional Digital Maturity Scores — Gambia average 19.9/70, regional mean 21.2/70. Strongest Gambian sector: Marketing/Publishing (38/70). Weakest: Fashion & Design (14/70).*
- One bright spot: multi-country Senegal + Gambia packages score significantly higher on creative tourism than pure Gambia tours, suggesting regional framing unlocks creative visibility.
- *Deliverable 2, Table 11: Pure Gambia tours avg Creative Tourism Score 16.9; Senegal + Gambia tours avg 33.9 — more than double.*

✦ **Activity:** Perception gap prompt (15 min): Ask participants to write down three words they believe international visitors would use to describe The Gambia today, and three words they

would want visitors to use. Share in pairs, then brief group discussion. Facilitator notes recurring themes on a board. This surfaces assumptions before presenting data and creates a personal anchor for the session findings.

↔ **Alternate:** If the group is small or senior, skip the written exercise and open with the question verbally, facilitating a brief discussion before presenting the data. This works better when participants may feel self-conscious about writing tasks.

NB: Ground this session in existing GT Board priorities — present findings as an external view to complement internal strategy, not contradict it. If any repositioning work is underway, acknowledge it explicitly and frame the session as supporting that process.

Session 2 — Destination Brand Coordination: The Institutional Role (75 min)

Reframing the Institutional Role

- The starting point for this session is a shift in framing: institutions are not the marketers of The Gambia — they are the enablers of marketing done by hundreds of SMEs, operators, and creative enterprises.
- The question is not 'how do we promote The Gambia?' but 'how do we make it easier for others to promote it well, consistently, and coherently?'
- Three institutional roles to explore: setting standards (what should Gambian tourism look and feel like?), providing tools (what do SMEs need to communicate well?), and coordinating narratives (how do we avoid conflicting messages?).

How Other Destinations Manage Brand Ecosystems

- Survey of regional and international examples — not as prescriptions but as illustrations of what coordination looks like in practice.
- Cape Verde: small island destination that has built strong international identity through consistent editorial tone and language accessibility — achieved without major infrastructure investment.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 2: Cape Verde performs best with a limited number of editorial platforms and sustains continuous international visibility for its music and cultural identity.*
- Senegal: high institutional capability with uneven diffusion — major festivals and museums achieve professional visibility, but smaller enterprises remain sporadic online.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 2: Senegal demonstrates strong institutional presence (Museum of Black Civilizations, major festivals) but private sector digital maturity remains patchy.*
- Ghana: strong diaspora engagement model — uses diaspora audiences as a distribution channel for cultural content, reaching international markets through community rather than advertising.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 2.2: Ghana's Global Mamas craft brand blends fair-trade credibility with process-led storytelling, achieving international e-commerce without large marketing budgets.*

Managing Sector Diversity Within a Unified Narrative

- The Gambia's creative industries are diverse — festivals, crafts, heritage sites, music, performing arts, fashion, media — and each has its own identity and audience.
- The institutional challenge is to help these sectors feel like they belong to the same destination without flattening what makes each distinct.
- One framing worth exploring: a 'Made in Gambia' logic — similar to how artisan certification schemes work — where individual products and experiences carry a shared signal of quality and origin without losing their specificity.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 2 cross-sector synthesis: 'The most effective craft brands show the human process, maintain visual coherence across channels, and make it easy for global audiences to learn, trust, and purchase.' The same logic applies at the destination level.*
- Practical tools institutions can develop and distribute: shared messaging frameworks, photography guides, brand toolkits, content calendars — things SMEs can adapt rather than build from scratch.

The World Bank Branding Work — Navigating Parallel Processes

- Acknowledge explicitly that national brand identity work is underway — this session is not about defining or replacing that.
- The focus here is on coordination and coherence at the operational level: how institutions help the sector communicate consistently, whatever the national brand ultimately becomes.
- Frame it as: 'Whatever the destination brand is, institutions have a role in making sure the sector can carry it.'

✦ **Activity:** Institutional touchpoint mapping (15 min): Each participant lists the ways their institution currently interacts with, supports, or communicates with SMEs in the tourism and creative industries sector. Pairs share lists, then the facilitator maps these on a shared board, identifying overlaps, gaps, and areas where coordination between institutions could reduce duplication or strengthen impact.

↔ **Alternate:** If participants are from a single institution, adapt the activity: map the touchpoints of the institution as a whole across different SME types (accommodation, operators, craft, culture), and identify where the strongest and weakest connections currently are.

◆ **Discussion:** Morning reflection (20 min): What resonates from the two sessions so far? What feels most urgent or most challenging from an institutional perspective? What questions remain before the afternoon?

NB: This session should feel exploratory rather than prescriptive. The 'Made in Gambia' framing is one idea worth introducing — but present it as a way of thinking, not a recommendation. The goal is for participants to leave with a richer vocabulary for talking about brand coherence, not a new mandate.

THURSDAY AFTERNOON — Reading the Landscape (~3h20)

Session 3 — Reading the Landscape: Data, Intelligence, and What It Tells You (90 min)

Why Most Institutions Don't Use Data — and Why It Matters

- Open with an honest observation: most tourism institutions in developing countries make decisions based on anecdote, relationship, and instinct rather than systematic data. This is understandable — data collection takes time and resources — but it creates blind spots.
- The case for data is not about sophistication. It's about asking: 'Is what we think is happening actually happening?' Three things data can tell you that instinct can't: how you appear to people who've never heard of you, how you compare to places competing for the same visitors, and whether things are getting better or worse over time.
- The good news: a meaningful amount of useful intelligence is freely available and doesn't require specialist skills to access.

Types of Intelligence Available at the Destination Level

- Visitor profiles and source market trends — who is coming, from where, and what they're looking for.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 4.4: Five traveler clusters identified from review data — UK/Anglophone (45%), Dutch/Belgian (34%), Francophone (15%), German/Swiss (3%), Southern European (3%). Each has distinct priorities and pain points that should inform institutional decisions.*
- Digital performance signals — how visible the destination is in the places people search before they travel.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 2.1: Digital maturity assessed across six dimensions: social media presence, website functionality, visual content quality, online discoverability, booking capability, and platform integration. These same dimensions can be used by institutions to audit their own presence and that of key stakeholders.*
- Online reviews and reputation data — what visitors actually say after they've been, which is often different from what marketing promises.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 4: 5,682 TripAdvisor reviews analyzed across six West African destinations. Key finding: The Gambia scores highest regionally in safety and competitive in artistic quality, but weakest in facilities/infrastructure and educational value — a gap that suppresses overall satisfaction even when core experience is strong.*
- Tour operator portfolios — how The Gambia is being packaged and sold internationally, which is often the single most influential factor in where visitors choose to go.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 3: 239 tour pages from 32 operators across 13 source markets analyzed. 81% of pure Gambia tours score below 20/100 on creative tourism content — meaning the country is almost exclusively sold as a beach and wildlife destination in international distribution channels.*

Walkthrough: How the Regional Benchmarking Was Done

- Walk participants through the methodology of Deliverable 2 — not to teach research skills, but to show what questions were asked and how publicly available information was used to answer them.
- Key questions the analysis asked: How visible are Gambian creative industries compared to regional peers? How do international tour operators represent The Gambia? What do visitors say about their experiences, and does it vary by nationality?
- Key sources used: operator websites (publicly accessible), TripAdvisor (publicly accessible), Google Business profiles (publicly accessible), social media channels (publicly accessible). No proprietary data required.
- The point for institutions: this kind of reading is possible without commissioning a study. It requires time, a clear set of questions, and a systematic approach — all things institutions can build into regular practice.

Free and Low-Cost Tools for Ongoing Monitoring

- Google Trends: track search interest in 'The Gambia' as a destination over time and by geography. Compare with Senegal or Cape Verde. Free, no account required.
- TripAdvisor: read recent reviews of key attractions, check star rating trends over time, note recurring themes in positive and negative feedback. Free, no account required.
- Google Alerts: set up alerts for 'The Gambia tourism' or 'Gambia travel' to receive email notifications when new content appears online. Free, requires a Google account.
- Operator catalogue spot-checks: once per quarter, visit the websites of five to ten key operators selling The Gambia and note how the country is described, what experiences are featured, and what images are used. No tools required — just a browser and a checklist.
- The digital dashboard approach: agree on a small set of indicators — perhaps six to eight — track them quarterly, and share results across institutions. The value is not sophistication but consistency.
- *Deliverable 2, Table 20: KPI framework proposed for destination monitoring — includes creative tourism visibility in ITO itineraries, average online sentiment score, verified TripAdvisor reviews, and average review rating. These can be adapted as a starting institutional dashboard.*

✦ **Activity:** Live walkthrough (15 min): Open a real international tour operator page selling The Gambia on screen. Walk through it together with participants — what creative content is present? What is missing? How is the country described? What images are used? Then open The Gambia's TripAdvisor destination page and read two or three recent reviews together. Ask: what would you act on if you saw this? This grounds the data conversation in something immediately recognisable.

↔ **Alternate:** If technology is unreliable, prepare printed one-page extracts from two or three operator pages and two or three reviews in advance. Participants work in pairs to annotate what they notice, then share back. Achieves the same outcome without requiring a live internet connection.

NB: The emphasis throughout this session is building the habit of landscape reading, not technical sophistication. Participants should leave knowing two or three things they can actually check next month — not feeling that they need new tools, new staff, or new budget to get started.

Session 4 — Supporting SMEs: From Training to Sustainable Market Access (75 min)

What SMEs Actually Need Beyond Training

- Training builds knowledge and skills — but knowledge alone does not generate market access. The gap between 'can do' and 'does' is where institutions have the most important role.
- Three things SMEs consistently need beyond training: visibility (being findable by the right audiences), credibility (being trusted by buyers and platforms), and connectivity (being linked to the distribution channels where international travelers make decisions).
- Institutions are uniquely positioned to provide or broker all three — not by doing it for SMEs, but by creating the conditions that make it possible.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 5 personas: The five visitor personas (Market Explorer, Heritage Seeker, Learning Traveler, Nature Connector, Dutch Immersive Explorer) each have specific digital needs that SMEs struggle to meet alone — multilingual content, booking functionality, structured itinerary inclusion. These are areas where institutional support or aggregation can make a systemic difference.*

Mapping Existing vs. Missing Support Services

- Before designing new support, it's worth mapping what already exists — many gaps are coordination failures rather than genuine absences.
- Common existing services: trade fair participation support, occasional training, some access to government platforms. Common gaps: ongoing coaching, content production support, platform listing assistance, connection to international buyers.
- The most valuable institutional contribution is often not a new service but reducing friction in accessing existing ones — making it easier for SMEs to find, apply for, and use what's already available.

Practical Institutional Support Approaches

- Coaching and mentoring infrastructure: building a pool of trained mentors who can provide ongoing, contextualised support to SMEs after formal training ends. More sustainable than repeated training cycles.
- Facilitating access to platforms, buyers, and trade fairs: institutions have relationships and credibility that individual SMEs lack. Using these to open doors — introductions to OTAs, inclusion in operator familiarisation trips, support for trade fair participation — is high-value and relatively low-cost.

- Content and visibility support: institutions can commission, curate, or coordinate photography, video, and written content that SMEs use in their own marketing. A shared content library reduces duplication and raises quality across the sector.
- *Deliverable 2, Table 18 (Digital Lever 3): 'Authentic Gambia' Visual Brand Campaign — commission professional photo/video library of artisans, festivals, and heritage sites; make available to operators and SMEs. Estimated impact: high; estimated effort: low.*

From One-Off Interventions to Sustainable Support Models

- The pattern in most development projects: intensive support during the project cycle, followed by a drop-off when funding ends. This is the single biggest risk to the sustainability of what has been built this week.
- Building sustainability requires two things: institutionalising the support within existing mandates (so it doesn't depend on project funding) and creating peer-to-peer networks (so SMEs support each other rather than relying entirely on institutional provision).
- The most durable support structures are those that are simple enough to maintain with existing staff and resources — not those that require specialist skills or dedicated budget.

✦ **Activity:** Pairs discussion (15 min): 'What is one thing your institution could realistically do in the next six months to better support SME visibility or market access — without additional budget?' Each pair shares their answer. Facilitator captures themes and groups them by type of support (access, content, coaching, coordination). This surfaces what is actually possible rather than what is theoretically desirable.

↔ **Alternate:** If time is short, ask participants to write their answer on a card and post it on a shared board. Facilitator reads and groups the cards quickly, then opens a brief discussion on the most common themes. Achieves similar outcome in half the time.

◆ **Discussion:** Afternoon reflection (20 min): What support structures already exist that could be strengthened with relatively little effort? Where are the most critical gaps — the things that, if addressed, would make the biggest difference to SME performance? And what is the one coordination action that would require institutions to work together rather than separately?

NB: This session should reference specific examples from the SME training week where possible — what did participants observe about the SMEs they met, what needs were most visible, what would have made the biggest difference? The more grounded in the week's actual experience, the more relevant the discussion.

FRIDAY MORNING — Digital Ecosystem & Building Routines (~3h10)

Session 5 — Digital Ecosystem and Institutional Visibility (75 min)

Mapping the Current Digital Presence

- Start by acknowledging what exists: The Gambia has official tourism websites, social media accounts, and institutional platforms. The question is whether they are current, accurate, consistent, and actively maintained.
- Three common problems in destination digital ecosystems: outdated information (hours, prices, contacts that are no longer accurate), inconsistency (different messages on different channels), and abandonment (accounts or pages that were created for a project and then left inactive).
- 'Digital orphans' — platforms created by projects that end without a handover plan — are a particular risk. They appear credible to visitors but contain outdated or inaccurate information, actively undermining trust.
- *Deliverable 1 (Baseline Assessment): Platform governance and continuity identified as a systemic gap across Gambian creative industry stakeholders — many platforms exist but are not actively maintained or linked to each other.*

Platform Governance: Who Owns What

- For each major official platform (tourism website, social media accounts, Google Business profile, TripAdvisor listing), institutions should be able to answer: who has administrative access? Who is responsible for updates? What is the process when that person leaves?
- Platform governance is not a technical question — it is an organisational one. It requires clear ownership, documented processes, and regular review.
- A practical starting point: conduct a platform audit — list every official digital touchpoint, note when it was last updated, identify who has access, and flag any that are outdated or at risk.

The Institutional Role in Destination-Level SEO and Content

- Search engine optimisation (SEO) at the destination level means ensuring that when someone searches 'Gambia travel' or 'things to do in The Gambia,' they find accurate, compelling, and up-to-date information that reflects the full range of what the destination offers.
- Institutions have a specific role here that individual SMEs cannot play: creating and maintaining the central content hubs (official websites, portal pages) that other sites link to and that search engines treat as authoritative.
- Content aggregation — bringing together information about events, experiences, and operators in one accessible place — is one of the highest-value things an institution can do for destination visibility.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 6.2 (Digital Lever 10): Creative Tourism Calendar & Operator Toolkit — building an interactive online calendar aggregating craft, festival, and heritage events with booking contacts. Estimated impact: high; estimated effort: medium.*

Partnerships That Institutions Can Broker

- OTA partnerships: negotiating destination-level agreements with platforms like Booking.com, TripAdvisor Experiences, or GetYourGuide that make it easier for SMEs to list and be found. Individual SMEs rarely have the leverage to negotiate these; institutions do.
- Media and press partnerships: facilitating visits by travel journalists, bloggers, and content creators who cover The Gambia for international audiences. Institutions can identify, invite, and host these visits in ways SMEs cannot.
- Operator familiarisation trips: organising visits for international tour operators to experience Gambian creative tourism products firsthand — the most direct route to being included in operator portfolios.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 3.4: 'To close the gap, Gambia's strategy should prioritize curated storytelling partnerships with operators already active in the region, develop bookable creative-industry products, and provide ready-to-use bilingual marketing materials that translate community-based creativity into itineraries recognizable to global buyers.'*

Seasonal Visibility and Crisis Management

- The off-season problem: The Gambia's tourism is heavily seasonal, but source market audiences are not. Maintaining digital presence year-round — through content, events coverage, and social media — keeps the destination visible during the planning phases that precede peak travel.
- Crisis and reputation management: negative reviews, press coverage, or social media moments require a response. Institutions should have a clear protocol: who monitors, who decides on a response, who communicates, and in what timeframe.
- A simple protocol: designate one person per institution responsible for monitoring. Agree on a response threshold (e.g., any review below 3 stars on an official platform gets a response within 48 hours). Agree on tone and messaging guidelines for responses.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 4.3: Tour operators are The Gambia's best digital ambassadors — review sentiment +0.32, rating 4.7/5. Negative feedback focuses on transport conditions rather than service delivery. Institutions can address transport perception through messaging even before physical improvements are made.*

✦ **Activity:** Assessment exercise (15 min): Participants are given a simple one-page checklist covering the key elements of destination digital health (official website currency, social media activity, TripAdvisor listing accuracy, Google Business profile completeness, operator presence). Working individually or in pairs, they assess The Gambia's current status against each item. Brief group share-back. This makes the gap concrete without requiring prior research.

↔ **Alternate:** Prepare three printed examples in advance — one strong destination digital ecosystem (e.g., Cape Verde's official tourism presence), one weak one, and The Gambia's current state. Groups compare and discuss what the differences mean for how international visitors perceive and find each destination.

NB: This session is deliberately practical and grounded in current reality. Avoid framing it around ideal-state infrastructure that requires significant investment. The emphasis is on what is

achievable with existing capacity — governance, process, and coordination — rather than technology or budget.

Session 6 — Monitoring Progress: Building a Simple Intelligence Routine (80 min)

What Good Monitoring Looks Like — and What Is Realistic

- The goal of destination monitoring is not to produce comprehensive reports — it is to maintain awareness of whether things are moving in the right direction, and to catch problems early enough to respond.
- For institutions with limited capacity, the key word is routine. A simple check done consistently every month is more valuable than a sophisticated analysis done once every two years.
- Three questions a monitoring routine should answer: Are we being found by the right audiences? Are the people who visit having the experience we want them to have? Are things getting better or worse over time?

A Simple Monitoring Framework

- Quarterly operator catalogue check: visit the websites of ten key operators selling The Gambia. Note how the country is described, which experiences are featured, what images are used, and whether creative industries are present. Record findings in a simple spreadsheet. Compare quarter-on-quarter.
- Monthly review sentiment scan: read the most recent twenty TripAdvisor reviews for key attractions and the destination overall. Note recurring themes — both positive and negative. Flag anything that requires a response. Track whether sentiment is improving, stable, or declining.
- Annual benchmarking snapshot: once a year, assess The Gambia's digital presence using the same framework as the baseline assessment — social media, website, discoverability, booking capability. Compare year-on-year to track progress.
- *Deliverable 2, Table 20: Proposed KPI framework — baseline 2025 targets and 2026 targets set for creative tourism ITO visibility (52% → 60%), average sentiment score (+0.24 → +0.30), verified TripAdvisor reviews (39 in 2024 → +25% increase), and average review rating (4.06 → 4.20). These provide a ready-made starting framework that institutions can adopt.*

Sharing Intelligence With SMEs

- The monitoring routine has limited value if findings stay within institutions. The goal is to translate intelligence into guidance that SMEs can act on.
- Practical formats for sharing: a one-page quarterly briefing summarising what the data shows and what it means for SMEs; a short email update when something significant changes (a new operator starts selling The Gambia, a cluster of negative reviews

appears about a specific issue); an annual meeting where institutions share findings and SMEs respond with ground-level experience.
- The tone matters: findings should be presented as 'here is what we are seeing and what it might mean for you,' not as evaluation or judgment. The goal is to build a shared understanding of how the destination is performing, not to assess individual businesses.

Connecting Monitoring to Coordination

- Monitoring is most powerful when institutions do it together rather than separately. Shared data creates shared understanding, which is the foundation for coordinated action.
- A lightweight coordination mechanism: a quarterly call or meeting between key institutions (GT Board, NCAC, sector associations) where each shares what they have observed, identifies common themes, and agrees on any joint responses or actions.
- The investment required is small — two to three hours per quarter — but the return is significant: institutions that share intelligence are far more likely to avoid duplicating effort, respond consistently to crises, and identify opportunities that no single institution would spot alone.
- *Deliverable 2, Section 6.3: Implementation roadmap proposes quarterly partner coordination meetings as a core governance mechanism, with GT Board as lead coordinator and custodian of the Digital Positioning Opportunities Matrix. These meetings are the natural vehicle for shared monitoring.*

✦ **Activity:** Monitoring plan draft (20 min): Each participant drafts a simple one-page monitoring plan for their institution — what they will track (choose three to four indicators), how often (monthly, quarterly, or annually), who will be responsible (name a specific role, not just 'the institution'), and how they will share findings with SMEs. Pairs exchange plans and offer one piece of feedback each. Brief share-back: what commitments have been made, and where might institutions support each other?

↔ **Alternate:** If participants are from a single institution, work as a group to produce one shared monitoring plan. Assign specific indicators to specific roles within the institution. This creates accountability and avoids the plan remaining abstract.

◆ **Discussion:** Reflection on sustainability (20 min): What would it take to make this monitoring routine stick beyond the project cycle? What are the realistic barriers — time, skills, political will? How might institutions support each other in maintaining it? Is there one person or one mechanism that could serve as the anchor for coordination?

NB: This session is deliberately low-tech. The monitoring framework proposed requires no specialist software, no dedicated budget, and no new staff. It requires only time, consistency, and a willingness to share findings. Frame the activity as building a habit, not designing a system.

FRIDAY AFTERNOON — Exchange & Close (up to 3pm, ~2 hours)

Wrap-Up Session — Priorities, Commitments, and Coordination

Part 1 — What We Learned (30 min)

- Facilitator-led synthesis: draw out three or four key themes from across the two days — the ideas that came up repeatedly, the findings that surprised people, the tensions that remain unresolved.
- Participant reflection: ask each person to identify the one finding or idea from the workshop that was most useful or most surprising. Brief round-table share.
- Grounding question: what confirmed existing assumptions, and what challenged them? This distinguishes between what was new and what was validation — both are useful, but they call for different responses.

Part 2 — Priority Actions (45 min)

- Each institution identifies one or two concrete actions they will take in the next three months. These should be specific enough to be checkable — not 'improve our digital presence' but 'conduct a platform audit and identify three outdated pages to update by June.'
- Actions are captured on a shared board and grouped by theme: monitoring, content, coordination, SME support, platform governance.
- Discussion: where would coordination between institutions amplify individual efforts? Are there any actions that two or more institutions could do together more effectively than separately?

Part 3 — Coordination Mechanisms (30 min)

- Practical question: how will institutions stay in contact and share intelligence after the workshop? Not in an aspirational sense — agree on something specific and achievable.
- Suggested minimum: a quarterly check-in between GT Board and NCAC (plus any willing sector associations) to share monitoring findings and agree on any joint actions. Format can be a call, a brief meeting, or a shared document — whatever is most likely to actually happen.
- If there is appetite for more: discuss whether a lightweight newsletter or briefing note shared across institutions and select SMEs could serve as the vehicle for ongoing intelligence sharing.

Closing (15 min)

- Facilitator closing remarks: acknowledge the investment participants have made across the week, summarise the connective thread between the SME training and the

institutional workshop, and frame the next step as maintaining momentum rather than starting something new.
- Participant reflections: one word or phrase describing what each person is taking away. Go around the room.
- Formal close.

NB: The Friday afternoon session is deliberately participant-led. The facilitator's role is to synthesise and prompt, not to present. By this point in the week, the most valuable thing is structured conversation that produces something specific and agreed — not more content. If energy is low, shorten Part 1 and give more time to Parts 2 and 3, where the concrete commitments live.